

Although discourse markers often don't add content in themselves, they can ease the flow of a conversation and add information about the speaker's opinion.

 **New language** Informal discourse markers

Aa Vocabulary Advanced prefixes

 **New skill** Structuring conversation

65.1 KEY LANGUAGE COMMON INFORMAL DISCOURSE MARKERS

Use "actually" to correct a listener's misunderstanding or incorrect expectation.

TIP

Be aware of how body language conveys extra meaning when talking face-to-face.

I don't think this painting is worth that much.



Actually, it sold at auction for \$2 million.

Wow! Do you like it?

I don't, **actually**. It's not very impressive.



Use "by the way" to show a change of subject.



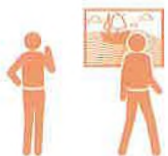
I think this one is fantastic, too.
Oh, **by the way**, did you read the article about the painter in *The Times*?

Use "as I was saying" to return to a previous subject after a change of subject or interruption.



As I was saying, this is a fantastic painting. I really like the way the sea is painted.

Use "anyway" to return to a subject after interruption, change subject, or end a topic or conversation.



Anyway, I should say goodbye. I want to visit the gallery shop before it closes.

